



BUDGET BURST

GRACED BY A LONG LIST OF LUMINARIES, THE INDIA TODAY-BUSINESS TODAY BUDGET ROUND TABLE PROVIDED DEEP INSIGHTS INTO THE ANNOUNCEMENTS MADE IN BUDGET 2023-24 BY TEAM BT

PHOTOS BY **MANISH RAJPUT**

THE SMILE WAS RESPLENDENT. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman has not had an easy time helming the economy in some of the most difficult years in recent times. Life was made difficult by the Covid-19 pandemic and the consequent economic slowdown in India, followed by the shock of war in Ukraine that tore supply chains asunder and thrust the West onto the threshold of a recession. As inflation spiked, exports slowed, and the rupee fell,

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